



Trans 101 Glossary Simplified

Trans 101 Glossary Simplified is a short, simplified version of our full glossary, *Trans 101 Glossary: transgender terms and how to use them* (2023).

For a deeper understanding, including cautionary notes, please see the full version, available at genderminorities.com

ISBN (paperback) 978-0-473-69892-8
ISBN (PDF) 978-0-473-69893-5

Gender or gender identity. *Ira, tuakiri ā-ira.*

Refers to a person's recognition of themselves as male, female, or something else. 'Social gender' = how a person is perceived, 'Registered gender' = gender recorded on identification documents.

Transgender. *Irawhiti, irahuri.*

1. A person whose gender is different from the sex they were assigned at birth.
2. An umbrella term uniting trans people regardless of medical transition.

Transsexual.

1950's term for trans people who seek to change their bodies, often through surgeries. Caution.

Trans.

Abbreviation of transgender or transsexual, or an umbrella similar to 'transgender'.

Cis, cisgender, or cissexual.

A person who identifies with the gender assigned to them at birth.

Cishet.

A contraction of cisgender and heterosexual, meaning a person is both.

Gender expression or presentation. *Whakaputa ā-ira.*

The outward expression of one's gender; for example through clothing, voice, body shape, and behaviors.

Sex.

A socially constructed system for assignment and classification of people, typically as male or female. Social sex = how a person is perceived. Sex assigned at birth = based on genitals at birth. Registered sex = sex registered on identity documents.

Sex characteristics. *Āhuatanga ā-ira*.

Historic: what was seen as typical and innate characteristics for a man or woman - spiritual essence, appearance, clothing, behaviors, sexual orientation. Contemporary: many still think that ways of thinking and behaving are characteristics based on sex. Others use 'sex characteristics' to refer to 'primary and secondary sex characteristics' e.g. genitalia, reproductive organs, chromosomes, sex hormones, distribution of hair, fat and muscle.

Variations of sex characteristics. *Rerekētanga āhuatanga ā-ira*.

Generally refers to a person having different physical sex characteristics than what is typical for their gender. Commonly applied to intersex individuals, who have innate variations of sex characteristics which do not fit into a male/female binary model. Sometimes applied to transgender individuals, whose innate sex characteristics are different from others of their gender.

A.F.A.B. and A.M.A.B.

Acronyms: Assigned Female (or Male) At Birth. When it's necessary to refer to the birth-assigned sex of a trans person, this is the best way to do it. Caution: when discussing intersex.

The gender binary / sex binary.

Unscientific theory that only 2 sexes/genders exist, with mutually exclusive and unchangeable characteristics.

Gender essentialism or sex essentialism

Gender essentialism, or sex essentialism, is the theory that there are only two genders/sexes, and that each sex has innate, immutable, universal characteristics that are the same for all people of that sex, such as a common socialisation, spiritual essence, biology, or psychology.

Trans woman. *Ira tangata wahine, whakawahine*.

A woman who was assigned male at birth.

Trans man. *Ira tangata tāne, whakatāne*.

A man who was assigned female at birth.

Binary. *Tāhūrua*.

An adjective to describe the binary genders i.e. female/woman/girl or male/man/boy.

Non-binary. *Ira tāhūrua-kore, Tāhine*.

An umbrella term for all genders other than just female/woman/girl or male/man/boy

Transition. *Whakamana ira (gender affirmation)*.

A broad term referring to changes that transgender people make as part of being transgender. Can include social, medical, or other changes.

Sexual orientation. *Aronga taera*.

A social categorisation of a person's pattern of sexual instinct, erotic desire, physical, emotional, spiritual, or psychological attraction to particular demographics of people (often by gender).

Asexual orientation. *Aronga taera-kore*.

Asexuality = an explicit absence of sexual instinct or erotic desire. Asexual orientation = a person's enduring pattern of non-sexual and non-erotic physical, romantic, emotional and/or spiritual attraction to others.

Romance, romantic.

The dominant cultural framework for understanding and organising social expectations of behaviors in sexual relationships, including specific methods of displaying attraction and affection i.e. dating, monogamy, marriage. May refer to positive feelings a person has about certain types of relationships and experiencing specific types of courtship.

Bisexual. *Taerarua*.

Bisexuality is a sexual orientation. Most bisexual people identify their attractions as being toward men and women. In LGBT social scenes, it is more common for bisexual people identify as being attracted to more than one gender, or to their own and other genders.

Pansexual. *Taerarau*.

Pansexual is a sexual orientation that either does not consider gender, or is toward people of any gender. It inherently, explicitly includes transgender and non-binary genders. Some pansexuals experience attractions based on characteristics other than gender.

Heteroflexible or homoflexible.

Similar to bisexual or pansexual, but with a stated heterosexual or homosexual preference respectively.

Chaser.

A person who sees trans people as inherently sexual, and sexually objectifies them.

Heteronormative or hetero-normativity.

The idea that relationships between cis men and cis women are normal, natural, or right, while all other relationships are viewed as abnormal, inferior, or wrong in contrast.

Queer.

Broadly used to indicate that one rejects heteronormativity and is not heterosexual – though sometimes queer is also used by heterosexual transgender people. Radical leftist connotations/history.

Genderqueer. *Irakē*.

Similar to queer, but specific to rejecting binary genders. Genderqueer people may identify as neither male nor female, may see themselves as outside or in between the binary genders, or may feel restricted by gender labels or having to define themselves.

Sexqueer.

A rejection of labeling one's physical body as female or male. Caution: do not confuse with intersex.

Intersex. *Taihemarua*.

Intersex describes a range of conditions where a person has an innate variation of sex characteristics from birth which is ambiguous in the context of the male/female sex binary. Can be an umbrella term for people who have an intersex condition, and is sometimes used as an individual identity. Most intersex people do not see themselves as transgender or rainbow.

Cross-dresser.

Someone who enjoys dressing as other genders. Can include people who primarily identify with their gender assigned at birth. Cross-dressing is a form of gender expression and may be an integral part of a person's identity. Caution.

Queens, drag queens, drag kings, drag.

Drag queens and drag kings are cross-dressing performers who take on stylised, exaggerated gender presentations for show. For many, this is also an integral part of their identity. Caution.

Gender fluid. *Irahuri*.

Genderfluid can refer to a person whose gender changes over time, often between multiple binary or non-binary genders. Caution.

Bi-gender.

A non-binary gender identity that indicates having two different genders. They could be male or female, or be any other two genders. Caution: do not confuse with Two-spirit (a First Nations gender).

Neutrois and agender. *Irakore*.

One who feels neutral in their gender, or an absence of gender, or who rejects the influence of gender on their person.

Androgyne.

A person who feels both masculine and feminine, or who has a gender expression with both masculine and feminine characteristics. Caution.

Femme.

An identity or presentation of non-heteronormative, reclaimed, queer femininity.

Butch.

An identity or presentation of non-heteronormative, reclaimed, queer masculinity.

Gender dysphoria. *Tīrengi ā-ira*.

A clinical diagnostic term referring to dissonance between one's assigned gender and/or body, and their personal sense of self.

Gender Euphoria

Theoretically the opposite of gender dysphoria. Sometimes used to describe positive feelings when a person's gender respected, due to expecting a lack of respect (e.g 'a nice surprise'). Caution.

Detransition or retransition

Retransition (or detransition) is when a person who previously identified as transgender now identifies as cisgender, or a different transgender identity (e.g. they used to identify as non-binary, they now identify as a trans woman).
Caution.

Transphobia. *Mae irawhiti, mae irahuri.*

Transphobia consists of three main parts – anti-trans stereotypes, anti-trans prejudice, and anti-trans discrimination. Any of these elements on it's own can be transphobia.

Transmisogyny.

Discrimination against trans women, AMAB transgender people, and some intersex people who are perceived as transfeminine. It involves the combination of misogyny, or hatred of women, with transphobia. A key aspect of transmisogyny is the double bind; trans women are presumed to embody the worst of “masculinity”, while also being treated with the worst of misogyny.

TMA/TME.

TMA is an acronym that stands for "Transmisogyny Affected," an umbrella term for everyone who is targetted and/or affected by transmisogyny. TME is an acronym that stands for "Transmisogyny Exempt," an umbrella term for people who are not the target of transmisogyny.

T.E.R.F.

TERF is an acronym for Trans Exclusionary Radical Feminist. Trans exclusionary radical feminism focuses on categorising trans women as men, and removing transgender human rights, legal protections, healthcare access, and supportive social environments.

Cissexism and cissupremacy.

Refers to systems of bias which advantage cis people over trans people, or systems of belief that cis people are inherently superior to trans, more real, more natural, etc.

Passing.

Being perceived as the gender one wishes to be perceived as. This term is becoming unpopular as it is seen to imply that one should desire to look cisgender.

Closeted and stealth.

Closeted refers to people who have not transitioned, and whose transgender identity is a secret. Stealth refers to people who have already transitioned, and whose trans history is a secret.

Bottom surgery, SRS, or GRS.

Sexual Reconstruction Surgery (SRS) or Genital Reconstruction Surgery (GRS), refer to several different types of gender affirmation or transition related surgical procedures which alter the patient's genitalia.

Rainbow, SOGIESC, and MOGAI. *Takatāpui, te hunga āniwaniwa.*

Rainbow is an umbrella term similar to LGBT+. SOGIESC stands for Sexual Orientation, Gender Identity, Gender Expression and Sex Characteristics, and MOGAI stands for Marginalised Orientations, Gender Alignments and Intersex.

Māori and Pacific terms

Many of the Te reo words in this glossary were developed in 2019 in collaboration with Te Ipukarea – The National Māori Language Institute. Some are older terms. For more information, please see *Trans 101 Glossary: transgender terms and how to use them, version 6*. Available at genderminorities.com

Te hunga āniwaniwa.

Rainbow community or rainbow people.

Te hunga - a group

āniwaniwa - rainbow.

Takatāpui.

Contemporary use of 'takatāpui' most often refers to Māori rainbow people as a group, or to tāne moe tāne (men who sleep with men), or wāhine moe wāhine (women who sleep with women).

Irawhiti.

Transgender.

Ira – gender, spirit, or essence.

Whiti – to change, transfer, transpose, or cross over.

MVPFAFF+

MVPFAFF+ is an acronym meaning Mahu (Hawai'i and Tahiti), Vaka sa lewa lewa* (Fiji), Palopa (Papua New Guinea) Fa'afafine and Fa'atama (Samoa) Akava'ine (Rarotonga), Fakaleiti (Tonga), Fakafifine (Niue) plus other Pacific genders such as Haka huahine (Tokelau) and Rae rae (Tahiti).

Caution: *often considered an offensive term.

Tāhine, or ira tāhūrua-kore.

Mixed gender, or non-binary.

Tāhine is a lexical blend of the words tāne and wahine.

Ira - gender, spirit, essence Tāhūrua - binary

Kore - not.

Whakamana ira.

Gender affirming, or to have pride in ones gender.

Whakamana – to affirm, to enact mana.

Ira – gender, spirit, or essence.

Irahuri.

Gender fluid. Sometimes this can also mean transgender.

Ira – gender, spirit, or essence.

Huri – turn, change, move.

Irakē.

Genderqueer, or alternative gender.

Ira – gender, spirit, or essence.

kē – different, alternative.

Ira tangata wahine.

Trans woman.

Ira - gender, spirit, essence

Tangata - person

Wahine/wāhine - woman (singular/plural)

Ira tangata tāne.

Trans man.

Ira - gender, spirit, essence

Tangata - person

Tāne - man

Whakawahine, fa'afafine, fakaleiti, and akava'ine.

Trans woman.

Similar to fa'afafine of Samoa, fakaleiti of Tonga, and akava'ine of the Cook Islands.

Whaka - to create or become.

Wahine - woman (wāhine plural).

Whakatāne, fa'atama, akatāne.

Trans man.

Whaka - to create or become.

Tāne - man.

* Note: the original use of Whakatāne was 'in the manner of a man'.

Whakaputa ā-ira.

Gender expression.

Whakaputa – express, expression.

ā-ira – relating to gender, spirit, or essence.

Irapūmau.

Cisgender, or permanent fixed gender.

Ira – gender, spirit, or essence.

Pūmau – fixed, constant, permanent.

Tuakiri ā-ira.

Gender identity.

Tuakiri – identity.

ā-ira – relating to gender.

Tīrengi ā-ira.

Gender dysphoria or anxiety.

Tīrengi – unsettled, uneasy, anxious.

ā-ira – relating to gender.

Tikanga ā-ira whānui.

Gender norms.

Tikanga whānui – code, convention practiced widely.

ā-ira – relating to gender.

Rerekētanga āhuatanga ā-ira.

Variations of sex characteristics.

Rerekētanga - difference, variation.

āhuatanga - circumstance, situation.

ā-ira - relating to gender/sex.

Irakore.

Agender, or no gender.

Ira – gender.

Kore – none.

Mae irawhiti, or mae irahuri.

Anti-trans, or transphobia.

Mae – phobia.

Irawhiti – transgender.

Irahuri – transgender.

Irahuhua.

Gender diverse, gender variance.

Ira – gender.

Huhua – abundant, numerous.

Huri ā-ira.

Gender fluidity.

Ira – gender.

Huri – turn, change, move.

Taihemarua.

Intersex.

Taihema (short for taihemahema) - sexual or reproductive anatomy.

Rua - two.

Taera, Taeratanga.

Sexual attraction, Sexuality.

Aronga taera.

Sexual orientation.

Aronga - focus, interest, desire

Taera - sexual desire.



ISBN (paperback) 978-0-473-69892-8

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Illustration by Lavinia Knight

Graphic Design by Te Ahi Wi-Hongi

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